



A FREE GUIDE FROM SCRAPPY STACKS

Legit in a Weekend

The paperwork that makes it official — explained plain, no law degree required.

“Own your work. Own your life.”

Why “Someday” Keeps You Stuck

Most people running a business on the side put the paperwork off. You've got customers, you're getting paid, so it feels done already. It isn't.

Without the paperwork, you're personally on the hook if something goes wrong, you can't open a real business bank account, and you can't sign a contract that actually protects you. “Someday” is doing a lot of work to avoid a weekend's worth of forms.

This guide walks through what actually matters and why — it's not legal advice for your specific situation, and a real business always benefits from a lawyer or accountant familiar with your state. Think of this as the map, not the trip.

The Three Things That Actually Matter

Registering the business. Most people running a service business on their own register as an LLC. It separates your personal stuff — your house, your car, your savings — from what happens in the business. Filing usually happens through your state's Secretary of State website, and costs vary by state.

A business bank account. The moment money for the business and money for your life mix in one account, you lose the protection the LLC was supposed to give you, and tax season turns into archaeology. Most banks just need your LLC paperwork and an EIN (a free number from the IRS, not a paid service) to open one.

A real contract. A text thread agreeing to “\$400 for the fence” isn't something you can enforce if it goes sideways. A simple one-page agreement — what you're doing, what it costs, when it's due — covers almost every situation a small service business runs into.

What Order to Do It In

Register the business first — everything else needs that paperwork to exist. Get the EIN next, since it's free and takes minutes. Open the bank account third. Draft (or get) your contract template last, so you can start using it on the very next job.

Most people can get through all four in a weekend if they sit down and do it, rather than researching it in five-minute bursts between other things. The research is usually the slow part, not the paperwork itself.

When You'd Rather It Just Get Done

Starter sets up your LLC, bank account, and contracts for you — along with a real website and your brand — starting at \$697/mo.

No contracts to sign for the privilege. Pause or cancel anytime.

scrappystacks.com | hello@scrappystacks.com